chapter VI of the Convention.
1.4.2 Alt
hough this Code is legally treated as a mandatory instrument under the SOLAS Convention, the
following provisions of this Code remain recommendatory or informative:
Sec
tion 11 Security provisions (except 11.1.1);
Sec
tion 12 Stowage factor conversion tables;
Sec
tion 13 References to related information and recommendations;
App
endices other than appendix 1 (Individual schedules of solid bulk cargoes) and appendix 5
(Bulk Cargo Shipping Names in three languages (English, French and Spanish)); and
The t
exts in the sections for Description, Characteristics (other than Hazard classification),
Hazard and Emergency procedures of individual schedules of solid bulk cargoes
in appendix 1.
1.4.3 In ce
rtain parts of this Code, a particular action is prescribed, but the responsibility for carrying
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
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in appendix 1.
1.4.3 In ce
rtain parts of this Code, a particular action is prescribed, but the responsibility for carrying
out the action has not been specifically assigned to any particular person. Such responsibility may
vary according to the laws and customs of different countries and the international conventions into
which these countries have entered. For the purpose of this Code, it is not necessary to make this
assignment, but only to identify the action itself. It remains the prerogative of each Government to
assign this responsibility.
1.5 Exem
ptions and equivalent measures
1.5
.1 Whe
re this Code requires that a particular provision for the transport of solid bulk cargoes shall
be complied with, a competent authority or competent authorities (port State of departure, port
State of arrival or flag State) may authorize any other provision by exemption if satisfied that such
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State of arrival or flag State) may authorize any other provision by exemption if satisfied that such
provision is at least as effective and safe as that required by this Code. Acceptance of an exemption
authorized under this section by a competent authority not party to it is subject to the discretion
of that competent authority. Accordingly, prior to any shipment covered by the exemption, the
recipient of the exemption shall notify other competent authorities concerned.
1.5.2 A com
petent authority or competent authorities which have taken the initiative with respect to the
exemption:
.1 sha
ll send a copy of such exemption to the Organization, which shall bring it to the attention

of the Contracting Parties to SOLAS; and
.2 sha
ll take action to amend this Code to include the provisions covered by the exemption, as
appropriate.
1.5.3 The p
eriod of validity of the exemption shall be not more than five years from the date of
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appropriate.
1.5.3 The p
eriod of validity of the exemption shall be not more than five years from the date of
authorization. An exemption that is not covered under 1.5.2.2 may be renewed in accordance with
the provisions of this section.
1.5.4 A cop
y of the exemption or an electronic copy thereof shall be maintained on board each ship
transporting solid bulk cargoes in accordance with the exemption, as appropriate.
1.5.5 Con
tact information for the main designated national competent authorities concerned is given in
the separate document issued by the Organization.
7
RESOLUTION MSC.539(107) (adopted on 8 June 2023)
2023 AMENDMENTS TO THE
INTERNATIONAL MARITIME SOLID BULK CARGOES (IMSBC) CODE
Non-commercial use only
1.6 Conv
entions
Par
ts A and B of chapter VI and part A-1 of chapter VII of the SOLAS Convention, as amended, deal
with the carriage of solid bulk cargoes and the carriage of dangerous goods in solid form in bulk,
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with the carriage of solid bulk cargoes and the carriage of dangerous goods in solid form in bulk,
respectively, and only the relevant parts are reproduced below.
Chapt
er VI
Car
riage of cargoes and oil fuels
Part A
Gen
eral provisions
Regu
lation 1
Application
1 Unl
ess expressly provided otherwise, this chapter applies to the carriage of cargoes (except liquids in bulk,
gases in bulk and those aspects of carriage covered by other chapters) which, owing to their particular hazards
to ships or persons on board, may require special precautions in all ships to which the present regulations apply
and in cargo ships of less than 500 gross tonnage. However, for cargo ships of less than 500 gross tonnage,

the Administration, if it considers that the sheltered nature and conditions of voyage are such as to render the application of any specific requirements of part A or B of this chapter unreasonable or unnecessary, may take other
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application of any specific requirements of part A or B of this chapter unreasonable or unnecessary, may take other effective measures to ensure the required safety for these ships.
2 To su
pplement the provisions of parts A and B of this chapter, each Contracting Government shall ensure that appropriate information on cargo and its stowage and securing is provided, specifying, in particular, precautions necessary for the safe carriage of such cargoes.
Regu
lation 1-1
Definitions
For t
he purpose of this chapter, unless expressly provided otherwise, the following definitions shall apply:
1 IMS
BC Code means the International Maritime Solid Bulk Cargoes (IMSBC) Code adopted by the Maritime Safety Committee of the Organization by resolution MSC.268(85), as may be amended by the Organization, provided that such amendments are adopted, brought into force and take effect in accordance with the provisions
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SOURCE: MSC.539(107).pdf
URL:
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provided that such amendments are adopted, brought into force and take effect in accordance with the provisions of article VIII of the present Convention concerning the amendment procedures applicable to the annex other than chapter I.
2 Soli
d bulk cargo means any cargo, other than liquid or gas, consisting of a combination of particles, granules or any larger pieces of material generally uniform in composition, which is loaded directly into the cargo spaces of a ship without any intermediate form of containment.
8
RESOLUTION MSC.539(107) (adopted on 8 June 2023)
2023 AMENDMENTS TO THE
INTERNATIONAL MARITIME SOLID BULK CARGOES (IMSBC) CODE
Non-c
ommercial use only
Reg
ulation 1-2
Requirements for the carriage of solid bulk cargoes other than grain
The
carriage of solid bulk cargoes other than grain shall be in compliance with the relevant provisions of the IMSBC Code.
Regu
lation 2
Cargo information
1 The s

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IMSBC Code.
Regu
lation 2
Cargo information
1 The s
hipper shall provide the master or their representative with appropriate information on the cargo sufficiently in advance of loading to enable the precautions which may be necessary for proper stowage and safe carriage of the cargo to be put into effect. Such information shall be confirmed in writing and by appropriate shipping documents prior to loading the cargo on the ship.
2 The c
argo information shall include:
.1 in th
e case of general cargo, and of cargo carried in cargo units, a general description of the cargo, the gross mass of the cargo or of the cargo units, and any relevant special properties of the cargo. For the purpose of this regulation the cargo information required in sub-chapter 1.9 of the Code of Safe Practice for Cargo Stowage and Securing, adopted by the Organization by resolution A.714(17), as may be amended,
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for Cargo Stowage and Securing, adopted by the Organization by resolution A.714(17), as may be amended, shall be provided. Any such amendment to sub-chapter 1.9 shall be adopted, brought into force and take effect in accordance with the provisions of article VIII of the present Convention concerning the amendment procedures applicable to the annex other than chapter I;
.2 in th
e case of solid bulk cargo, information as required by section 4 of the IMSBC Code.
3 Pri
or to loading cargo units on board ships, the shipper shall ensure that the gross mass of such units is in accordance with the gross mass declared on the shipping documents.
4 In th
e case of cargo carried in a container, except for containers carried on a chassis or a trailer when such containers are driven on or off a ro-ro ship engaged in short international voyages as defined in regulation III/3, the gross mass according to paragraph 2.1 of this regulation shall be verified by the shipper, either by:
.1 wei

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